

The Book of Quinte Essence or the Fifth Being (1889)

Frederick James Furnivall



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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE BOOK OF
QUINTE ESSENCE OR THE FIFTH BEING (1889) ***

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The

Book of Quinte Essence

or

The Fifth Being;

That is to say,

Man's Heaven.

A tretice in englich breuely drawe out of þe book of quintis
eessencijs in latyn, þat hermys þe prophete and
kyng of Egipt, after þe flood of Noe
fadir of philosophris, hadde by
reuelacioun of an aungil
of god to him
sende.

Edited from
British Museum MS. Sloane 73
about 1460-70 A.D.
by
FREDERICK J. FURNIVALL

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The odd account of the origin of this Treatise—in its first lines—caught my eye as I was turning over the leaves of the Sloane Manuscript which contains it. I resolved to print it as a specimen of the curious fancies our forefathers believed in (as I suppose) in Natural Science, to go alongside of the equally curious notions they put faith in in matters religious. And this I determined on with no idea of scoffing, or pride in modern wisdom; for I believe that as great fallacies now prevail in both the great branches of knowledge and feeling mentioned, as ever were held by man. Because once held by other men, and specially by older Englishmen, these fancies and notions have, or should have, an interest for all of us; and in this belief, one of them is presented here.

The loss of my sweet, bright, only child, Eena, and other distress, have prevented my getting up any cram on the subject of Quintessence to form a regular Preface. The (translated?) original of the text is attributed to Hermes—Trismegistus, “or the thrice great Interpreter,” so called as “having three parts of the Philosophy of the whole world”¹—to whom were credited more works than he wrote. The tract appears to be a great fuss about Alcohol or Spirits of Wine; how to make it, and get more or less tipsy on it, and what wonders it will work, from making old men young, and dying men well, to killing lice.

The reading of the proof with the MS. was done by Mr. Edmund Brock, the Society’s most careful and able helper. To Mr. Cockayne I am indebted for the identification of some names of plants, &c.; and to Mr. Gill of University College, London, for some Notes on the Chemistry of the treatise, made at the request of my friend Mr. Moreshwar Atmaram.² The Sloane MS. I judge to be about, but after, A.D.³ The later copy (Harleian MS. 853, fol. 66) seems late 16th century or early 17th,³ and has been only collated for a few passages which require elucidation. The pause marks of the MS. and text require to be disregarded occasionally in reading.

EGHAM, 16th May, 1866.

P.S. The short side-notes in inverted commas on and after p. 16 (save '5 M^e' and the like) are by a later hand in the MS. The 'Spheres' on p. 26, and the 'Contents,' p. vii-viii, are now added.—F. 1889.

1. *The Mirror of Alchimy*, composed by the thrice-famous and learned Fryer, Roger Bachon, 1597.
2. Mr. M.A. Tarkhad has been for many years Vice-Principal of the Rajkumar College, for the sons of the native Chiefs of Rajkote.—1889.
3. Mr. E.A. Bond of the British Museum has kindly looked at the MSS., and puts the Sloane at 1460-70 A.D., and the Harleian at about 1600.

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THE BOOK OF QUINTE ESSENCE

OR THE FIFTH BEING;

THAT IS TO SAY,
MAN'S HEAVEN.

[Sloane MS. 73, fol. 10. Brit. Mus.]

BOOK I.

[Fol. 10.]

With þe myȝt, wisdom, & grace of
þe holy trynite, I write to ȝou a
tretice in englich breuely drawe out of
þe book of quintis essencijs in latyn, þat
hermys þe prophete and kyng of Egipt,
after the flood of Noe, fadir of
philosophris, hadde by reuelacioun of
an aungil of god to him sende, þat þe
wijsdom and þe science of þis book
schulde not perische, but be kept and
preserued vnto þe eende of þe world, of
alle holy men from al wickid peple and
tyrauntis, for greet perilis þat myȝte
falle þerof. For wiþinne þis breue tretis,
wiþ þe grace of god, I wole more
determine of practif¹ þan of theorik. ȝitt
ben boþe nedeful /

The firste and souereyneste priuyte þat
god, maker of kynde, ordeyned for
mannys nede, how þat olde euangelik
men, and feble in kynde, myȝte be
restorid, and haue aȝen her firste
strenkþis of ȝongþe in þe same degree
þat is in al kynde, & be mad hool
parfiȝtly,

except þe strok of þe þundir blast, &
violent brusuris, and oppressynge of to

By the grace of God I
translate you this
Treatise revealed to
Hermes by an angel
after Noah's flood, that
the knowledge of this
book may be preserved
to the end of the world.

God's greatest secret
for man's need is how
to restore old feeble
men to the strength of
their youth,

except in case of
thunder-blast, and too

THE NAMES
AND
QUALITIES
OF QUINTE
ESSENCE.

[* Fol. 10b.]

myche betynge / Also perilous fallyngis
of hiȝ placis, to myche abstynence, &
opere yuel gouernaunce aȝens kynde,
And also þe teerme þat is sett of god,
þat noman may a-schape, as Iob seiþ in
latyn /

“Breues dies hominis sunt &c.”

Forsoþe philosophoris clepen þe purest
substaunce of manye corruptible þingis
elementid, ‘quinta essencia,’ þat is to
seie, ‘mannys heuene,’ drawe out by
craft of mani;² for whi, as quinta
essencia superior, þat is, heuene of oure
lord god, in reward of þe .iiij elementis,
is yncorruptible & vnchaungeable /

riȝt so *quinta essencia superior
inferior, þat is to seie, mannys heuene,
is incorruptible, in reward of þe .4.
qualitees of mannys body; and so it is
preued naturally þat oure quinta
essencia, þat is, mannes heuene, in it-
silf³ is incorruptible; and so it is not
hoot and drie wiþ fier / ne coold and
moist wiþ watir / ne hoot & moist with
eyr, ne coold and drie wiþ erþe; but oure
quinta essencia awayliþ to þe contrarie,
as heuene incorruptible /

But vndirstonde þat oure qui[n]ta
essencia is nouȝt so incorruptible as is
heuene of oure lord god; but it is
incorruptible in reward of composicioun
maad of þe .4. elementis;

& it hath .iiij. names by the
philosophoris, þat is to seie / brennyng
watir / þe soule in þe spirit of wyn, &

much fasting, and the
term set for all men.

‘Nota.’

The purest substance of
corruptible things is
Quinte Essence or
man’s heaven.

Quinte Essence is
incorruptible as to the
four qualities of man’s
body,

but not as the heaven of
God.

It is called, 1. Burning
Water; 2. the Soul in
the spirit of Wine; 3.
Water of Life; and if

watir of lijf / But whanne 3e wole
concelle it, þanne schal 3e clepe it ‘oure
quinta essencia’; for þis name, & þe
nature þerof, riȝt fewe philosophoris
wolde schewe / but sikurly þei biriede
þe truþe with hem. and witip weel that it
is clepid brennyng watir; and it is no
brennyng watir:

you wish to conceal it,
Quinte Essence.

forwhi, it is not moist ne coold as
comoun watir; for it brennep, & so doiþ
not comyn watir;

It is neither moist and
cold like water,

ne it is nat hoot and moist as eir, for eir
corrumpiþ a þing a-noon, as it schewiþ
weel by generacioun of flies, & areins,
and siche opere; but sikirly þis is alwey
incompactible, if it be kept cloos fro
fliȝt /

nor hot and moist like
air,

Also it is not coold and drie as erþe. for
souereynly it worchip & chaungiþ. And
it is not hoot and drie as fier, as it
schewiþ by experience; for hoot þingis
it keliþ, & hoot sicknessis it doiþ away /

nor cold and dry like
earth, nor hot and dry
like fire.

[* Fol. 11.]

Also þat it 3eueþ incompactibilite, and
kepiþ a þing fro corruptibilite *and
rotyng, it is preued þus / Forwhi. what
pece of fleisch, fisch, or deed brid, be
putt þerinne, it schal not corru[m]pe ne
rote whilis it is þerinne /

It gives incompactibility,
for it prevents dead
flesh from rotting,

miche more þanne it wole kepe quyke
fleisch of mannys body from al manere
corruptibilite and rotyng / This is oure
quinta essencia, þat is to seie, mannys
hevene, þat god made to þe
conseruacioun of þe .4. qualitees of
mannys body, riȝt as he made his

and much more the
living flesh of man. It is
Man’s Heaven,
preserving his body as
Heaven does the world.

THE NATURE
AND
WORKING OF
QUINTE
ESSENCE.

heuene to þe conseruacioun of al þe
world /

And wite 3e for certeyn þat manye
philosophoris and lechis þat ben now,
knowe nou3t þis quinta essencia, ne þe
truþe þerof / Forwhi; god wole not þat
þei knowe it; for her greet brennyng
coueitise & vicious lyuynge /

Forsope quinta essencia superior, þat is
to seie, heuene of oure lord god bi him
silf / Aloone / 3eueþ not conseruacioun
in þe world, and wondirful influence,
but by þe vertue of þe sunne, planetis,
and opere sterris; ri3t so oure quinta
essencia, þat is, mannys heuene, wole
be maad fair wiþ þe sunne mineralle,
fynynd, schynyng, incorruptibile; and
euene in qualite þat fier may not
appeire, corruppe, ne distroie. and þis is
verry gold of þe myn, of þe erþe, or of
þe floodis gaderid /

for gold of alkamy maad *with* corosyues
distroieþ kynde, as aristotle and manye
opere philosophoris prouen /

and þefore good gold naturel, & of þe
myn of þe erbe, is clepid of
philosophoris ‘sol’ in latyn; for he is þe
sonne of oure heuene, lich as sol þe
planet is in þe heuene aboue; for þis
planete 3eueþ to gold his influence,
nature, colour, & a substaunce
incorruptible.

[* Fol. 11b.]

And oure quinta essencia, mannys
heuene, is of þe nature *& þe colour of
heuene / And oure sol, þat is, fyn gold

Many know it not now
for their covetousness
and vice.

But as God’s Heaven is
aided by sun and stars,
so our Heaven, or
Quinte Essence, is
made fair by the sun
mineral, or pure gold of
the mine, not of
alchemy.

‘Nota.’

Good natural gold is
called *Sol*, because *Sol*
the planet gives gold its
power, colour, &c.

Our Quinte Essence is
the colour of heaven;
gold makes it fair; and
the two work in us (so

of þe myne, schal make it fair, riȝt as sol
þe planete makip̃ heuene fair / and so
þese two togidere ioyned schal ȝeue
influence in us, and þe condiciouns of
heuene and of heuenly sonne / in as
miche as it is possible in deedly nature,
conseruacioun and restorynge of nature
lost, & renewynge of ȝongþe /

And it schal ȝeue plenteuously heelp̃e:
and so it is preued by astronomy aboue,
þat sterris þat haþ influence vpon þe
heed and þe necke of man / as ben þe
sterris of aries, taurus, and gemini,
ȝeuen influence syngulerly vpon
Gerapigra galieni /

And þerfore it haþ a synguler strenkþe,
by þe ordynaunce of god, to drawe
away þe superflue humouris fro þe
heed, þe necke, and þe brest, and not fro
þe membris byneþe / And so I seie of
spicis þat drawip̃ humouris fro þe knees,
þe leggis, and þe feet, þat resseyuen a
synguler influence of þe sterris of
Capricorn, Aquarie and pisces, & riȝt so
of *opere, et cetera* /

Comounne ȝe not þis book of deuyne
secretes to wickid men and auerous; but
kepe ȝe it in priuytee /

THE 1ST WAY
TO MAKE
QUINTE
ESSENCE.

Take þe beste wiyn þat ȝe may fynde, if
ȝe be of power; & if ȝe be riȝt pore,
þanne take corrupt wiyn, þat is, rotyn,
of a watery humour, but not egre, þat is,
sour, for þe quint essencia þerof is
naturaly incorruptible þe which ȝe schal
drawe out by sublymacioun / And þanne

far as is possible)
renewal of youth, and
give health plenteously.

As Aries, Taurus, and
Gemini draw humours
from the head and
breast, and not the
limbs beneath,
'Nota.'

so those spices that do
draw from these limbs
get their power from
Capricorn, &c.

Tell not these Divine
secrets to wicked men.

'aqua vite'

To make Quinte
Essence.

Take the best wine, or
any not sour; distil it,
and the 4 Elements
shall be left like dregs.

schal *per* leue in þe ground of þe vessel
þe .4. elementis, as it were, rotun fecis
of wiyn /

[* Fol. 12.]

But firste 3e muste distille þis wiyn .7.
tymes; & þanne haue 3e good
brennyng watir / Forsoþe, þis is þe
watri mater *fro which is drawe oure
quinta essencia /

Thanne muste 3e do make in þe furneis
of *aischin*, a distillatorie of glas al hool
of oo. pece, wiþ an hoole a-boue in þe
heed, where þe watir schal be putt yn,
and be take out / And þis is a wondirful
instrument þat þat þing þat by vertues
of fier ascendith and distillith wiþinne
þe vessel, *per canales brachiales*, þat is,
by pipis lich to armys, be bore a3en, and
eftsoones ascendith, & eft descendip
contynuely day and ny3t, til þe
brennyng water heuenly be turned into
quintam essenciam / And so bi
continuelle ascenciouns & discenciouns,
þe *quinta essencia* is departid fro þe
corruptible composicioun of þe .4.
elementis.

For bifore þat þing þat is twies
sublymed is more glorified, and is more
sotil, and fer from þe corrupcioun of
þe .4. elementis more separat þan
whanne it ascendith but oonys;
and so vnto a þousand tymes, so þat by
coutynuel ascendyng and descendyng,
by the which it is sublymed to so myche
hiznes of glorificacioun, it schal come
þat it schal be a medicyn incorruptible

Distil 7 times to get
Burning Water;

‘vas’
put this in a Distiller in
a furnace, and let the
vapour rise, condense,
and be distilled till it is
turned into Quinte
Essence, and parted
from the 4 elements.

‘Nota.’

Distil it 1000 times,
and it shall be glorified
and become a medicine
incorruptible as heaven.

almost as heuene aboue, and of þe
nature of heuene / And þerfore oure
quinta essencia worþily is clepid
'mannys heuene' /

And aftir manye daies þat it hath be in
þis sotil vessel of glas distillid / 3e
schulen opene þe hoole of þe vessel in
þe heed þat was selid with þe seel of
lute of wijsdom, maad of þe sotillest
flour, and of white of eyren, and of
moist papere, ymeyngid so þat no þing
respire out /

[* Fol. 12b.]

And whane 3e opene þe hoole. if þer
come out a passynge heuently swete
flauour þat alle men þat come yn
naturely *drawe þerto. þanne 3e haue
oure quinta essencia /

and ellis sele þe vessel, and putte it to
þe fier a3en til 3e haue it.

After many days unstop
your distiller,
'lute'

and if there issues out a
heaven-sweet savour,
you have our Quinte
Essence.

If not, distil again till
you have.

THE 2ND,
3RD, AND
4TH WAYS OF
MAKING
QUINTE
ESSENCE.

And anoþer maner worchinge of oure
quinta essencia is þis / Take þe noblest
and þe strengest brennyng watir þat 3e
may haue distillid out of pure my3ty
wiyn, and putte it into a glas clepid
'amphora, with a long necke / and close
þe mouþ strongly wiþ wex; And loke
þat half or þe þridde part be fulle; and
birie it al in hors dounge, preparate as it
is seid hereafter / so þat þe necke of þe
glas be turned downward, & þe botum
be turned vpward, þat by vertu of þe
hors dounge þe quinta essencia ascende
vp to þe botum. And þe grosté of þe

The second way to
make Quinte Essence.

Put the strongest
Burning Water into an
'amphora;' seal it up;
bury it neck
downwards in horse-
dung, and the Quinte
Essence will rise into
the globe and the
impurities settle in the
neck.

mater of þe watir descende dounward to
þe necke /

And aftir manye daies, whanne 3e take
it out, softly lift vp þe glas as it stondith,
and 3e schal se in þickenes and
cleernesse a difference bitwene þe
quintam essenciam sublymed, and þe
grose mater þat is in þe necke / þe
wondirful maistry of departynge of þat
oon fro þat oþer is þis /

Take a scharp poyntel, or a pricke of
yren, & peerse into þe wax þat hongith
in þe mouþ of þe glas azens þe erþe /
and whanne 3e haue peersid al fully to
þe watir, take out þe poyntel or þe
pricke /

And þat erþely watir wole first come
out þat is in þe necke / and so til it be
come out vnto þe departinge bitwixe it /
and þe *quinte* essence, þat is, mannys
heuene sublymed.

[* Fol. 13.]

and whane 3e se þat þis *quint* essence
wole renne & melte aftir þat þis erþely
watir be voydid, putte þanne swiftly
3oure fyngir to þe hoole, & turne vp þe
glas, and þanne 3e haue þerinne oure
quinte essence, *and þe erþely watir
wipoute aside. And þis is a passyng
souereyn *priuytee*.

The þridde maner is, þat 3e take a greet
glas clepid *amphora*, and seele it weel,
and birie it weel in þe wombe of an hors
al togidere. and þe pureté of þe *quinte*
essencie schal be sublymed aboue, & þe

Take the glass out of
the dung;

make a hole in the wax
seal,

let out the impure
earthy water,

and when the *Quinte*
Essence would begin to
run, turn the glass up,
and keep your *Quinte*
Essence.

The third way.

Put your amphora into
a horse's belly instead
of the dung, and
proceed as above.

grosté schal abide byneþe in þe botme /
take out softli þat þat fletip a-boue; and
þat þat leeueþ bihynde, putte it to þe
fier.

The .iiij. maner is þis. take what vessel
of glas þat 3e wole, or of erþe strongly
glasid, and þer-vpon a round foot of
glas wip a leg. and seele þe vessel *with*
his couertour, þat þe rod of þe foot of
þe glas wipinne þe vessel honge in þe
eyr, þat þat þing þat ascendith to þe
couertour in þe maner of a pott boilynge
descende down azen by þe foot of þe
glas. and this instrument may 3e do
make wipoute greet cost /

The fifþe maner is, þat þe brennynge
water be .10 tymes distillid in hors
dounge contynuely digest.

The science of makynge of fier wipoute
fier / wherby 3e may make oure *quinte*
essence wipoute cost or traueile, and
without occupacioun and lesynge of
tyme /

Take þe beste horse dounge þat may be
had þat is weel digest, and putte it
wipine a uessel, or ellis a pitt maad wip
þe erþe anoyntid þoru3out *with* past
maad of aischin. And in þis vessel or
pitt, bete weel togidere þe dounge; And
in þe myddil of þis dounge, sette þe
vessel of distillacioun vnto þe myddis or
more / For it is nede þat al þe heed of þe
vessel be in þe coold eir /

The fourth way.

Substitute for the
amphora a vessel of
glass or earth, with a
tube running from the
top and hanging in the
air, into which the
vapour may fall and
condense.

The fifth way.

Distil your Burning
Water ten times.

*To make fire without
fire, and Quinte
Essence without cost or
trouble.*

Put horse-dung into a
vessel or pit lined with
ashes, and place your
vessel in it up to the
middle.

THE 5TH
WAY TO
MAKE
QUINTE
ESSENCE,
&C.

[* Fol. 13b.]

þat, þat þing þat bi vertu of þe fier of þe
dounþ þat ascendith þerby be turned
into watir *by vertu of cooldnes of þe
eir and falle doun aȝen and ascende vp
aȝen. and þus ȝe haue fier wiþoute fier,
and but wiþ litil traueile.

The cold top part will
condense the vapour
caused by the heat of
the dung.

Also anoþer maner of fier. sette ȝoure
vessel forseid to þe strong
reuerberacioun of þe sunne in somer
tyme, and lete it stonde þere nyȝt and
day.

Or, place your vessel in
the sun's rays.

Here I wole teche ȝou how pore
euangelik men may haue wiþoute cost,
and almoost for nouȝt, þe gracious
influence of gold, and þe maner of þe
fixynge of it in oure heuene, þat is, oure
quinta essencia.

How poor evangelic
men may get the
gracious influence of
gold.

if ȝe be pore, ȝe schal preie a riche man
þat is ȝoure freend to leene ȝou a good
floreyne of florence / and anele it vpon a
plate of yren as yren is anelid. and haue
biside ȝou a uessel of erþe glased, fillid
ful of the beste brennyng watir þat ȝe
may fynde. & caste into þe watir þe
floreyne anelid. and loke þat ȝe haue a
sotilte and a sleiȝþe to quenche
sodeynly þe fier, þat þe watir waaste
not; and be weel war þat non yren
touche þe watir. but af[t]er caste into þe
watir þe floreyne,

Borrow a Florence
florin of a rich friend,
anneal [?heat] it on a
plate of iron, and throw
it into some Burning
Water, taking care to
quench the fire quickly
to prevent the Water
wasting.

and do so .l. tymes or more, for þe
oftere þe bettere it is / And if ȝe se þat
þe watir waaste to myche, chaunge it

Repeat this 50 times in
fresh Water, and then
mix all the Waters
together.

HOW TO
GILD
BURNING
WATER OR
WINE.
[* Fol. 14.]

þanne, and take newe, & do so ofte
tymes. and whanne 3e haue do 3oure
quencheour, putte all þe watris togidere /

And 3e schulen vndirstonde þat þe vertu
of brennynge watir is sich þat naturely it
drawiþ out of gold alle þe vertues &
propirtees of it, & it holdiþ
incorruptiblitee & an euene heete.

*þanne meynge þis brennynge watir þus
giltid wiþ oure quinte essence, and vse
it. but be war þat 3e quenche not þe
floreyn in oure quinte essence; for
þanne it were lost /

And if it so be þat 3e haue not þis
brennynge watir redy, þanne quenche
3oure floreyn in þe beste whiȝt wiyn þat
may be had / For sikirly þe
philosophore seiþ, þat wiyn hath also þe
propirtee to restreyne in it þe influence
and vertues of gold / And whanne 3e
haue do 3oure werk, 3e schal wite þat þe
floreyn is als good, & almoost of þe
same weiȝte, as it was afore /

þerfore vse wiyn or brennynge watir
giltid, so þat 3e may be hool, and wexe
glad, and be 3ong. And þus 3e haue oure
heuene, and þe sunne in him fixid, to þe
conseruacioun of mannys nature and
fixacioun of oure heuene, þat is, oure
quinte essence.

The science how 3e schule gilde more
myȝtily by brennynge watir or wiyn þan
I tauȝte you tofore, wherby þe water or
þe wiyn schal take to it myȝtily þe

The Water draws out all
the properties of the
gold.

Mix the gilt Burning
Water with Quinte
Essence.

You may substitute for
Burning Water best
white wine, which also
retains the powers of
gold.

This gilt Water will
make you well and
young again.
In it you have the Sun
fixed in our Heaven.

‘science.’

How to gild Burning
Water or Wine more
thoroughly.

influence & þe vertues of fyne gold.

Take þe calx of fyn gold as it is declarid here-aftir in þis book, and putte it in a siluer spone, and anele it at þe fier. & þanne caste þe cals of the gold in þe brennyng watir or in wiyn .l. times, as I tauzte 3ou tofore wiþ þe floreyne.

[* Fol. 14b.]

and 3e schule haue 3oure licour by an hundrid part bettir gilt þan 3e had tofore wiþ þe floreyne / Forwhi. fier worchip more strongly and bettere *in sotil parties þan it doiþ in an hool plate / And also brennyng watir or wiyn drawiþ out more myztily bi a þousand part þe propirtees of gold fro smale parties anelid, þan it doiþ fro a þicke plate / And 3e schal vndirstonde þat wiyn not aloonly holdiþ in it þe propirtees of gold, but myche more þe propirtees of alle liquibles if þei be quenched þerinne. and þat is a souereyn priuite: Forwhi, if 3e quenche saturne liquified in wiyn or in comoun watir .7. tymes, and aftirward in þat wiyn or watir 3e quenche mars manye tymes, þanne mars schal take algate þe neischede and þe softnes of saturne /

And þe same schal venus do, & alle opere liquibles / or ellis, And 3e quenche mars in whi3t wiyn or in comoun watir manye tymes, and aftirward in þe same wiyn or watir 3e caste saturne liquified ofte tymes, þanne wiþoute doute 3e schal fynde þat þe

Heat calcined gold in a silver spoon and put it in Burning Water or wine 50 times, as with the florin before.

Your liquor will be better gilt, as the fire and Water or wine work more powerfully on the grains of gold than on a plate. Wine retains the properties of all liquibles quenched in it.

If Saturn (lead) liquefied be quenched in wine, and then Mars (iron) be quenched in it, Mars acquires the softness of Saturn.

Again, if you quench Mars in wine and put in it Saturn liquefied, this will be made hard.

saturne is *maad* riȝt hard / Therfore þe
propirtees of alle liquibles may be
brouȝt into wiyn or watir; but myche
more myȝtily into brennynge watir good
and precious.

TO MAKE
FIRE WITH
NO FIRE.

[* Fol. 15]

The science to make a fier, þat is,
wiþoute cole, *withoute* lyme, wiþoute
liȝt, worchinge azens al maner
scharpnes or accioun of visible fier, riȝt
as worchiþ þe fier of helle /

And þis priuytee is so vertuous, þat þe
vertu þerof may not al be declarid. And
þus it is maad. Take Mercurie þat is
sublymed *with* vitriol, * & comen salt, &
sał armoniac .7. or .10. tymes
sublymed / and meynge hem togidere
by euene porcioun. and grynde it smal,
and leye it abrood vpon a marbil stoon;
and by nyȝte sette it *in* a soft cleer eir, or
ellis in a coold seler; and þere it wole
turne into watir / And þanne gadere it
togidere *in* to a strong vessel of glas,
and kepe it /

This water forsoþe is so strong, þat if a
litil drope þerof falle vpon ȝoure hond,
anoon it wole perce it þoruȝ-out; and *in*
þe same maner it wole do, if it falle
vpon a plate of venus or Iubiter, into þis
watir, it turneþ hem into lijknys of peerl.
who so coude reparale & preparate
kyndely þis fier, wiþoute doute it wolde
quenche anoone a brennynge sijknys
clepid þe fier of helle. And also it wolde
heele euery cor[os]if sijknesse.

To make fire without
coals, lime, light, &c.

Mix equal parts of
sublimated Mercury,
Salt, and Sal
Ammoniac, grind them
small, expose them to
the air, and they'll turn
into water,

a drop of which will eat
thro' your hand, and
make Venus (copper) or
Jupiter (tin) like pearl.

If it could be moderated
it would cure the
disease Hell fire, and
every corrosive
sickness.

And manye philosophoris clepiþ þis
 þing in her bookis ‘sal amarus,’ al þouȝ
 þei teche not þe maistrie þerof / If it be
 so þat þis firy watir breke þe glas, and
 renne out into þe aischen, þanne gadere
 alle togidere þat ȝe fynde pastid in þe
 aischen / and leye it vpon a marbil stoon
 as afore, and it wole turne into watir.
 And þis is a greet priuytee.

‘sal amarus.’
 It is also called ‘Sal
 Amarus.’

TO CALCINE
 GOLD.
 [* Fol. 15b.]

The science to brynge gold into calx /
 Take fyn gold, and make it into smal
 lymayl: take a crusible wiþ a good
 quantitee of Mercurie, and sette it to a
 litil fier so þat it vapoure not, and putte
 þerinne þi lymail of gold, and stire it
 weel togidere / & aftirward *wiþinne a
 litil tyme ȝe schal se al þe gold wiþinne
 þe Mercurie turned into erþe as sotil as
 flour. þanne ȝeue it a good fier, þat þe
 Mercurie arise and go his wey;
 or ellis, and ȝe wole, ȝe may distille and
 gadere it, puttynge þer-vpon a lembike /
 and in þe corusible ȝe schal fynde þe
 gold calcyned and reducid into erþe /
 And if ȝe wole not make lymayl of gold,
 þanne make þerof a sotil þinne plate, as
 ȝe kan, and putte wiþinne þe Mercurie
 al warm; and ȝe schal haue ȝoure
 desier / And in þis same maner ȝe may
 worche wiþ siluir /
 Thanne take þe calx of þese two bodies,
 and bere hem openly wiþ ȝou; and þer
 schal noman knowe what þei ben / And
 if ȝe wole bere hem more priuily

‘Science.’

To calcine gold.

Cut gold into shavings;
 put it into a crucible
 with Mercury; heat it,
 and it will crumble into
 dust like flour.
 Heat it more till the
 mercury goes his way;

or distil it, and the gold
 powder will be in the
 crucible.

A thin plate of gold will
 do instead of shavings,
 and Silver may be
 treated like gold.

To carry these powders
 about, mix them with
 pitch, wax, or gum,

wipoute ony knowynge, þanne meynge
hem wip pich melt, or wex, or ellis
gumme, for þanne noman schal knowe
it what it is.

And whanne 3e wole dissolue ony of
þese calces by hem silf, putte eiþir by
him silf in a test, or ellis þe pich or þe
wex in which þei ben ynne; and anoon
schal come out verry gold & siluer as
þei were tofore.

melting the mass when
you want the metal.

Now I wole teche 3ou þe maistrie of
departynge of gold fro siluir whanne þei
be meyngid togidere / Forsoþe 3e woot
weel þat þer be manye werkis in þe
whiche gold and siluir be meyngid, as in
giltyng of vessel & Iewellis /

How to separate gold
from silver when mixed
with it.

[* Fol. 16.]

þerfore whanne 3e wole drawe þe toon
fro þat opir, putte al þat mixture into a
strong watir maad of vitriol and of sal
petre. and þe *siluyr wole be dissolued,
and not þe gold: þanne 3e haue þat oon
departid fro þe toþir /

Put the mixture into a
solution of vitriol and
saltpetre, and the silver
will be dissolved.

And if 3e wole dissolue þe gold to watir,
putte þanne yn þe watir corosyue, Sal
armoniac; and þat watir wipoute doute
wole dissolue gold into watir.

Corrosive water and sal
ammoniac will dissolve
the gold.

TO GET THE
QUINTE
ESSENCE
OUT OF
GOLD.

The science to drawe out of fyn gold v^{ta}
essencia is þis / First 3e schal reduce
gold into calx, as I tolde 3ou tofore /
þanne take vynegre distillid, or ellis
oold vryne depurid fro þe fecis, and
putte it in a uessel glasid; and þe liquor
schal be in þe hei3þe of 4. ynchis; and

‘science.’
‘Nota.’

How to get out of gold
its Quinte Essence.

Put calcined gold into
distilled vinegar or
purified urine; set it in
a hot sun; a film will

þerinne caste þe calx of gold, & sette it
to the strong sunne in somer tyme, þere
to abide / and soone aftir 3e schal se as
it were a liquor of oyle ascende vp,
fletynge aboue in maner of a skyn or of
a reme. gadere þat away wiþ a sotil
spone or ellis a feþere, and putte it into
a uessel of glas in þe which be putt
watir tofore. and þus gadere it manye
tymes in þe day, into þe tyme þat þer
ascende nomore /

and aftir do vapoure away þe watir at þe
fier. And þe v^{ta} essencia of þe gold wole
abyde byneþe. And manye
philosophoris clepiþ þis quinta essencia
an oile incombustible, þat is a greet
priuytee /

And if 3e wole fixe þis quinta essencia
in oure heuene, þat⁴ it may wiþoute
doute restore azen to man þat nature þat
is lost, and reduce him azen into þe
vertu of þe strenkþe of 3ongþe, and also
lenkþiþ his lijf into þe laste terme of lijf
set of god //

[* Fol. 16b.]

Now forsoþe I haue toold 3ou þe
souereynest *priuytee and restorynge of
mannys kynde, and in part greet þing
þat schulde not be schewid / Forwhi. þis
oyle, þat is to seie, quinta essencia of
gold, hath þe mooste swetnes and vertu
to a-swage and putte awei þe ache of
woundis, and for to heele woundis,
oolde sooris, and manye wondirful
yuelis / Also in þe same maner 3e may

soon rise; skim it off,
collect all such in a
glass vessel till no more
rise.

Evaporate the water
left; the residuum is the
Quinte Essence of
Gold.

And if you fix this
Quinte Essence in our
heaven, it will restore
man to the strength of
his youth.

Now I have told this
most sovereign secret,
which should not be
shewed.

[Nota.]

The Quinte Essence of
gold is best to heal
wounds.

drawe out of siluir, quinte essencie //

TO GET THE
QUINTE
ESSENCE
OUT OF
ANTIMONY,
&C.

The science to drawe out of antymony, þat is, mercasite of leed, þe v^{te} essencie, is a souereyn maistrie, and a priuytee of alle priuytees / Take þe myn of antymony aforeseid, and make þerof al so sotil a poudre as 3e kan / þanne take þe beste vynegre distillid, and putte þerinne þe poudre of antymonye, and lete it stonde in a glas vpon a litil fier into þe tyme þat þe vynegre be colourid reed. þanne take þat vynegre away, and kepe it clene, and putte azen þer-to of opere vynegre distillid, and lete it stonde vpon a soft fier til it be colourid reed. & so do ofte tymes. and whanne 3e haue gaderid al 3oure vynegre colourid, putte it þanne in a distillatorie. and first þe vynegre wole ascende; þanne after 3e schal se merueilis: for 3e schal se as it were a þousand dropis of blessid wiyn discende doun in maner of reed dropis, as it were blood, by þe pipe of þe lymbike / þe which licour, gadere togidere in a rotumbe / and þanne 3e haue a þing þat al þe tresour of þe world may not be in comparisoun of worþines þerto /

[* Fol. 17.]

aristotle seiþ þat it is his lede in þe book of secretis, al þou3 he *telle not þe name of þe antymonye aforeseid / Forsope þis doiþ away ache of alle woundis, and wondirfully heelip. þe

How to get its Quinte
Essence out of
Antimony.

Put powdered antimony into distilled vinegar; heat it till the vinegar is red; take away the red vinegar, and put fresh; take that away when red. Put the red vinegar into a distiller, and 1000 drops of blessed wine shall come down the pipe; collect this; it is an incomparable treasure.

[Nota.]

It cures the pain of all wounds,

vertu þerof is incorruptible &
merueilous profitable /
it nedit to be putrified in a rotombe and
seelid in fyme, and þanne it worchip
greet priuytees / Forsoþe þe v^{ta} essencia
of þis antymony þat is reed, in þe which
is þe secreet of alle secretis, is swettere
þan ony hony, or sugre, or ony oþir
þing.

and when fermented it
works great secrets.

TO EXTRACT
THE QUINTE
ESSENCE
FROM MAN'S
BLOOD.

The science in the extraccioun of þe .5⁵
essencie from blood, and fleisch, &
eggis / To 3ou I seie, þat in euery
elementid þing, þe .5. essencie
remayneþ incorrupte: it schal be þanne
þe moost þing of merueyle if I teche 3ou
to drawe out þat fro mannys blood
reserued of Barbouris whanne þei lete
blood; also fro fleisch of alle brute
beestis, and fro alle eggis, and oþere
suche þingis.

for als myche as mannes blood is þe
perfitist werk of kynde in us, as to þe
encrees of þat þat is lost, it is certeyn
þat nature þat .5. essence maad so
perfizt þat, wiþoute ony oþir greet
preparacioun wiþoute þe veynes, it
berip forþ þat blood anon aftir into
fleisch. and þis 5 essence is so ny3
kynde þat [it] is moost to haue⁶ /

Forwhy. in it is merueylous vertu of
oure heuene sterid, and to þe cure of
nature of man worchip moost deuyn
myraclis, as wiþinne I schal teche 3ou /

‘Science.’

How to get its Quinte
Essence from Man's
Blood.

Man's blood is the
perfectest work of
nature in us, and its
Quinte Essence
converts blood into
flesh,

and works divine
miracles of healing.

þerfore resceyue of Barbouris, of 3ong
sangueyn men, or colerik men, whanne
þei be late blood, þe which vse good
wynes. take þat blood aftir þat it hap
reste, and cast away þe watir fro it, and
braie it wiþ þe .10. part of comen salt
preparate to medicyns of men; and
putte it into a uessel of glas clepid
amphora,

[* Fol. 17b.]

þe which, sotely seele, and putte it
wiþinne þe *wombe of an hors,
preparate as tofore, and renewe þe fyne
oonys in þe wike, or more, and lete it
putrifie til al þe blood be turned into
watir / and it schal be doon at þe mooste
in xxx. or xl dayes, or aftir, more or
lasse / þanne putte it in a lembike, and
distille it at a good fier / what so euere
may ascende, putte þat watir vpon þe
fecis brayed, meyngynge vpon a marbil
stoon; putte it azen, and aftir distille it
azen manye tymes rehersynge /

And whanne 3e haue þis noble þing of
blood, þerof þe .5. beyng drawe out /
putte azen þe watir in þe stillatorie of
circulacioun til 3e brynge it to so myche
swetnes & an heuenly sauour, as 3e dide
þe brennyng watir. and þis is þe 5
beyng of blood deuyn, and miraclis
more þan man mai bileue but if he se it.

Get from Barbers the
blood of young
sanguine men; let it
stand; pour off the
serum; mix the blood
with a tenth of prepared
salt; put it in an
amphora;

seal that up; put it in a
horse's belly, renewing
the dung weekly till all
the blood turns into
water; distil that; put
the outcome on the
pounded fæces, and
distil over again.

Heat the water in the
distiller till it comes to
a heavenly savour. This
Fifth Being works
miracles hardly
credible unless seen.

TO GET THE
QUINTE
ESSENCE
OUT OF
BEASTS AND

Now wole I teche 3ou to drawe out þe .5
beyng from capouns, hennes, and al
maner fleisch of Brut beestis, and from
al maner eggis of foulis þat ben holsum

*To get the Quinte
Essence out of capons,
beasts, eggs, &c.*

Grind some of them
with a tenth part of

THE 4
ELEMENTS.

and medicynable to ete for mān kynde /
Grynde summe of þese þingis forseid,
which þat 3e wil, as strongly as 3e can in
a mortar, wiþ þe 10 part of him of sal
comen preparete to þe medicyne of
men, as I seide tofore. putte it in þe
wombe of an hors til it be turned into
water. distille as it is aforeseid, and in
þe stillatorie of circulacioun þe watir þat
is distillid, putte it in a3en til it be brou3t
to þe swete heuenly sauour and smel
aforeseid /

prepared salt; put 'em
into a horse's belly till
they become water, and
distil that till it's
heaven-sweet.

The science to drawe out þe 5 beynge of
euerych of þe .4 elementis, and to
schewe euerych of þe forseid þing bi
hem silf; & þat is ri3t merueylous / I
wole not leue for a litil to schewe a
greet secreet, how 3e may drawe out þe
5 beynge of ech of þe 4 elementis of al
þe þing rehersed afore, and profitably
schewe hem /

'science.'

To draw the Fifth Being
out of each of the Four
Elements, and to
separate them.

[* Fol. 18.]

And þe maner ys *þis / take þat þing
putrified and brou3t into watir, what so
euere 3e wole, as I tau3te 3ou tofore;
and þat þing be mannes blood brou3t
into watir, of þe which 3e wole drawe
out þe 4 elementis / putte þerfore þat
water, or þat blood putrified, in a
stillatorie of glas, and sette it wiþinne a
pott of watir, and 3eue vndirneþe a fier
til þe watir of blood be distillid by þe
pipe of þe lembike into a glas clepid
amphora, ri3t clene /

Take any thing rotted
and turned into water,
as man's blood; put it
in a glass distiller, and
distil it over into an
amphora.

And whanne no þing may more by þat
fier ascende, for certeyn 3e haue of
blood drawn out al oonly þe element of
watir / Forwhi. fier of þat bath hath no
strenkþe to sublyme eyr, or fier, or erþe.
and so [take] þo þre elementis, and sette
in þe same bath by .vij. dayes þat þei be
weel meyngid, & so cloos þat no þing
be distillid /

aftir þe .vij. dayes take þe stillatorie,
and putte it to þe fier of aischen, þat is
strongere þan fier of bath clepid marien;
and þe watir schal ascende in foorme of
oyle schynynge as gold /

and aftirward þat no þing more schal
ascende, 3e haue þanne in þe ampulle
.ij. elementis, þat is to seie, watir and
eyr. & oon from anopir 3e schal departe
in þe bath, puttynge yn a3en wher al-
oonly þe cleer watir schal ascende / and
þe eyr schal al-oonly remayne iñ þe
botum of þe vessel in lijknesse of oyle
of gold. þe which oyle þat is gold, þe
which oyle þat is ayr / putte it aside.

þanne þer leueþ 3itt fier wiþ erþe. to
departe fier from erþe, putte þe element
of watir, þat is to seye .iiij lb of watir,
vpon j lb of mater / and putte by .vij.
daies to encorpere wel as tofore in þe
bath of marien /

[* Fol. 18b.]

Aftirward putte it to þe fier of flawme
ri3t strong, and þe reed water schal
ascende. þe which gadere togidere as
longe as ony *þing ascendip. and to 3ou

When no more vapour
rises, you have drawn
out the water.

Put the other 3
elements for 7 days into
the same bath,

then into a coal fire,
and the water shall rise
as oil shining like gold,

the air remaining at the
bottom like oil of gold.
Put these aside.

To separate fire from
the earth, put 4 lbs. of
water on 1 lb. of earth;
place it in the Marian
bath for 7 days;

then in hot flames; red
water shall ascend and
black earth fall.

schal remayne an erþe riȝt blak in þe
botum. þe which gadere togidere aside /
þanne þe redeste watir 3e schal take.
forwhy. þer be .ij. elementis, þat is to
seie, þe element of watir and fier. þanne
yn þe stillatorie, to þe fier of baþ, cleer
watir schal asende. and in þe botum
schal remayne þe reed watir, þat is, þe
element of fier.

Put the red water into
the distiller; pure water
shall rise; red water, or
fire, shall remain;

and so 3e haue now first oon oyle, þat
is, ayer o side, and watir, and fier, and
erþe. and note 3e weel þat þerfore þe
element of watir is putt aȝen to drawe
out from erþe fier and eyr, for þei wole
not ascende, but þoruȝ þe help of
element of watir.

so you have the 4
Elements separate.

brynge aȝen euerych into 5 beynge wiþ
þe vessel of circulacioun as tofore / or
ellis rectifie, makynge oon ascende .7
tymes bi an opir / but first 3e moste þe
riȝt blak erþe of oon hide⁷ nature, in þe
furneys of glas mon⁸, or ellis
reuerberacioun, xxj. dayes calcyne /

Distil each into its
Quinte Essence, or
rectify it, and

And for a cause I speke to ȝou nomore
of this science. but ioie 3e, and thanke
oure glorious lord god of þese þingis þat
3e haue had.

thank our glorious God
for this bit of
knowledge.

HOW TO FIX
OTHER
THINGS IN
OUR QUINTE
ESSENCE.

The science to fixe alle erþely þingis in
nostra 5^{ta} essencia, þat is to seie, oure
heuene, þat by her influence þei may
ȝeue þerto þer propertees and her hid
vertues / oure glorious god haþ ȝeue
sich a uertu to oure quinta essence, þat
it may drawe out of euery matier of

To fix all earthly things
in our Quinte Essence.

God has given it the
power of drawing all
the virtues out of every
thing in 3 hours.

fruyzt / tree / rote / flour, herbe / fleisch,
seed & spice / And euery medicynable
þing, alle þe vertues, propirtees, and
naturis, þe whiche god made in hem;
and þat wiþinne .iiij. houris.

OUR QUINTE
ESSENCE
IMPROVES
EVERYTHING
100 FOLD.
[* Fol. 19.]

Now I haue schewid þou a souereyn
priuytee, how þat 3e may wiþ oure
heuene drawe out euery 5 essencia from
alle þingis aforeseid / þerfore alle
necessarie þingis to euery syrup putte
yn oure 5 essencie, & wiþinne .iiij.
houris þat watir schal be sich a sirup,
vndirstonde wel, bettir by an hundrid
part, by cause of oure 5 essencie, þan it
*schulde be wiþoute it /

And so I seie of medicyns
comfortatyues, digestyues, laxatyues,
restriktyues, and alle opere; forwhy. if
3e putte seedis or flouris, fruyztis,
leeues, spicis, coold, hoot, sweet, sour,
moist, do þei good or yuel, into oure 5
essencie, forsoþe sich 5 essence 3e
schulen haue þerfore.

oure 5 essencie is þe instrument of alle
vertues of þing transmutable if þei be
putt in it, encreessynge an hundrid foold
her worchingis //

Put therefore every
thing necessary for any
syrup into our Quinte
Essence, and in 3 hours
it shall be 100 times
better than before.

Whatever medicines
are put into our Quinte
Essence,

it increases their power
a hundred fold.

**Explicit pars prima tractatus
quinte essencie:**

End of Part I.

BOOK II.

TO MAKE OLD
MEN YOUNG,
AND DYING
ONES WELL.

Here bigynneth the secunde book of
medicyns / The first medicyn is to
reduce an oold feble euangelik man to
þe firste strenkþe of 3ongþe / Also to
restore a3en his nature þat is lost, and
to lenkþe his lijf in greet gladnesse and
perfizte heele vnto þe laste teerme of
his lijf þat is sett of god /

3e schal take oure 5^{ta} essencie
aforeseid, þat is to seye, mannys
heuene, and þerinne putte a litil
quantite of 5 essencia of gold and of
peerl. and þe oolde feble man schal
vse þis deuyn drynk at morn and at
euen, ech tyme a walnote-schelle
fulle /

and wipinne a fewe dayes he schal so
hool⁹ þat he schal fele him silf of þe
statt and þe strenkþe of xl 3eer; and he
schal haue greet ioie þat he is come to
þe statt of 3ongþe. And whanne his
3ongþe is recouerid, and his nature
restorid, and heelpþe had, it is nedeful
þat litil and seelde he vse 5 essence /
Also it is nedeful þat he vse ofte good
wiyn at his mete and at þe soper, in þe
which be fixid þe 5. essence of gold,
as I tau3te 3ou tofore.

*To restore an old
evangelic man to the
strength of his youth.*

Give him our Quinte
Essence with some of
that ‘1^a. M^e.’ of Gold
and Pearl, a walnut-
shell full at morn and
eve.

In a few days he shall
feel only 40 years old.
Then let him take little
of our Quinte Essence,
only that of Gold in
good wine at dinner
and supper.

[* Fol. 19b.]

The secunde *medicyn is to heele a
man, and make hym lyue, þat is
almoost consumed in nature, and so

‘2^a. M^e.’

*To cure a man given up
by his doctors.*

nyȝ deed þat he is forsake of lechis.
but if it be þe laste teerme of his lijf
sett of god, ȝe schal ȝeue him oure
quinte essence of gold wiþ a litil
quantite of watir of celendoyȝ ȝdrawe,
and meynge it wiþ þe oþere þingis
aforeseid / and anoon as þe sike hath
resceyued it into his stomak, it ȝeueþ
to þe herte influence of naturel heete
and of lijf. and þanne ȝe schal se him
rise vp and speke, and wondirfully be
comfortid and strenkþid þerby //

þanne comforte him wiþ ministracioun
of oure quinte essencie afore seid, and
he schal be al hool / but if it be so þat
god wole algatis þat he schal die / And
I seie to ȝou truly, þat þis is þe hizeste
maistrie þat may be in transmutacioun
of kynde; for riȝt fewe lechis now
lyuynge knowe þis priuytee.

HOW TO CURE LEPROSY AND PALSY.

The þridde medicyn is to cure þe lepre
þat is causid of corrupcioun and
putrifaccioun of ony of þe principal
humouris of man; but not þe lepre þat
comeþ to man of kynde of þe fadir and
of þe modir leprous,—for it is callid
morbus hereditus,—ne þe lepre þat is
sent of god by his plage, but þat þat is
causid oonly of rotun humouris /
take oure 5 essence aforeseid, wiþ þe
quinte essence of goold and peerl, a
litil quantite at oonyȝ, and vse it in
maner as I seide afore / and wiþinne a
fewe daies he schal be partily hool

Give him Quinte
Essence of Gold with
celandine water,
‘Aqua celidoyn.’
and he shall rise up and
speak.

Then comfort him with
our Quinte Essence,
and he shall be cured,
unless God wills he
shall die.
Few doctors now know
this highest secret.

‘ȝ^a. M^e.’

*To cure the Leprosy
that is caused by rotten
humours.*

Use our Quinte
Essence, with those of
Gold and Pearl;
(or Burning Water, if
you have no Quinte
Essence.)

þerof. and if 3e haue non *preparate*
redy oure 5 essence, þanne take in þe
stide þerof fyn brennyng watir / but
þat oþer is bettere.

[* Fol. 20.]

Also, drawe a water of þe fruyzt of
strawbery or mulbery tree, whanne it is
ripe, and waische þe lepre þerwiþ. þis
watir is of so greet vertu; for a
souereyn maistir took it a leprous
*womman, þat wiþ þe waischinge
oonly of þis watir, *withynne* schort
tyme was maad al hool / but sikirly þe
vertu þerof is myche worth if it be
meyngid *with* oure 5 essence, or ellis
brennyng watir; and þanne it schal be
no nede to vse in þis perilous cure,
venemys, as summe lechis doon.

Wash the leper with
strawberry or mulberry
water; this is of great
virtue, but is much
encreased by our
Quinte Essence.

The 4 medicyn is to cure palsie
vniuersel. Forsope alle philosophoris
seyn þat þe palesye vniuersel comep of
haboundaunce of viscus humouris
closynge þe metis of vertu animale,
sensityue, and motyue. And þerfore it
is necessarie þat þo þingis þat schal
cure þis sijknes be temperate, hoot,
and moist, and a litil attractyue, and to
þe synous confortatyue /

Therefore, blessid be god, makere of
kynde, þat ordeynede for þe man
paralitike oure 5 essence aforeseid, þat
souereynly to him comforynge,
restorynge, and temperatly
worchyng /

4^a. M^e.

*To cure Palsy, which
comes from viscus
humours closing the
passages of motive
power.*

Blessed be God, our
Quinte Essence will
restore the paralytic.

þerfore fixe þerinne þe 5 essence of þo
laxatyues þat purgen flewme &
viscous humouris, as a litil of euforbie,
or turbit, or sambucy. & þanne
wiþoute doute, if god wole, þe
paralitik man schal be hool wiþ
comfortynge and restorynge of kynde,
if 3e make him a stewe hoot and moist
with herbis, þat is to seye, eerbe yue,
& sauge, þat haue an heuenly strenkþe
to comforte þe joynctis, & þe senewis,
and þe vertu motyue.

and if 3e haue not redi *preparate* oure
5 essence, þanne take fyn brennynge
watir til it be redy, and lete þe pacient
drynke þerof a litil in fyn wiyn. and
also he schal waische al his body and
his *extremytees* wiþ brennynge watir
ofte tymes. and lete him vse þis a good
while, & he schal be hool. /

[* Fol. 20b.]
TO CURE
CONSUMPTION
AND DRIVE
AWAY DEVILS.

*The .5 medicyn for a man þat is
almoost al consumed, & waastid in al
his body, and riȝt leene, as þat man þat
hath þe tisik & þe etik / Forsoþe þe
verry cure to heele him is oure 5
essence / Forwhi. it comfortiþ þe feble
nature; and þe nature þat is lost it
restoriþ, & so restorid it *preserueþ* /
And þerfore if 3e wol restore þe fleisch
of a leene mannys body almoost
consumed away, drawe þanne a watir
of celidoyne, and take þerof a litil
quantite, and meynge wiþ oure 5
essence if 3e haue it redy, or

Fix in it the Quinte
Essence of euphorbium
and the like; and, if
God will, the palsied
man shall be whole, if
you make him a stew
of ivy and sage.

‘sawe’

‘Nota / yue / sauge.’

Failing Quinte
Essence, let him drink
Burning Water in fine
wine, and wash all over
with burning water.

‘5. Me.’

*To fatten lean and
consumptive men.*

Mix with our Quinte
Essence a little
celandine water;

‘Celidoyne.’

give it the patient, and
he shall soon be
wonderfully fat.

brennynge watir in stide þerof, and
zeue it him to drinke; and wiþinne
fewe dayes he schal be wondirfully
restorid and fat.

The .6. medicyn for passiouns of
frenesie, folly, ymagynaciouns and
noyous vexaciouns of deuelis, and also
for þe goute als weel hoot as coold.
certeyn experience techiþ þat colerik
men zeueþ to summe ymagynaciouns;
and sanguelyn men ben ocupied aboute
summe opere ymagynaciouns; & zitt
flewmatik men aboute opere / but þo
men þat habounde in blak coler, þat is,
malencoly, ben occupied a þousand
part wiþ mo þouztis þan ben men of
ony oper complexioun /

Forwhi. þat humour of blak coler is so
noyous, þat if it a-bounde and a-sende
vp to þe heed, it troublip alle þe myztis
of þe brayn, engendrynge noyous
ymagynaciouns, bryngyng yn
horrible þouztis boþe wakyng and
slepinge; and sicke maner of men ben
born vnder þe constillacioun of
saturne, the wickide planete /

Forsoþe, to sicke men deuelis wole
gladly appere, & minister to hem¹⁰
her priuy temptaciouns wiþinne þe
cours of her þouztis;

and þese men þus *turmentid wiþ þe
passiouns of malencoly comounly
speke wiþ hem, stryue and dispute wiþ
hem silf whanne þei be a-loone, þat

‘.6. M^e.’

*To cure Frensy, Gout,
and troubles from
Devils.*

‘colerike.’
‘Sanguelyn.’
‘Fleumatyke.’
‘blake coler.’
‘malencoly.’

Dark melancholy men
are troubled more with
anxieties than any
others,

‘Nota sequentia.’
being born under
‘Saturne, a wykyd
planete.’

Devils gladly appear to
them and tempt them,

so that they often fall
into despair and kill
themselves.

TO CURE
MELANCHOLY
AND DRIVE
OUT
TROUBLES
FROM DEVILS.
[* Fol. 21.]

ofte tymes oþere folk may heere it /
These maner of men þat ben þus
turmentid, as weel by passioun of
malencoly as of deuelis, ofte tymes
falle in dispeir, and at þe laste sle hem
silf /

þe perfizt cure of alle þese is oure 5
essencie auri *et perelarum*, or ellis
brennynge watir in stide þerof, in þe
whiche 3e fixe gold as it is aforeseid,
wherinne be putt a litil of señē or watir
of f[u]miter, or poudre of lapis lasuly,
or ellis *medullam ebuli*, and vse it
discreetly. forwhy. not al oonly oure
quinte essence auri et perelarum
heelith þese disesis. /

but also brennynge watir in þe which
gold is fixid, heelip hem, wiþ a litil of
þo þingis þat purgen and casten out
blak coler superflue, & helip þe
splene.

Forsoþe þese medicyns puttiþ away
wickid þou3tis and an heuy herte
malencolious; þei gladith and clense
þe brayn and alle hise my3tis, and
brynge yn gladnes and merye þou3tis.
þei putte away also þe craft of þe
feendis temptaciouns, and
ymagynaciouns of dispeir. þei distroie,
& make a man to for3ete almaner of
yueles, and naturally bryngip him a3en
to resonable witt.

and for as myche as saturne þe planete
naturally ys coold and drye, and is

The cure is our Quinte
Essence of Gold and
Pearls, with a little
senna or lapis lazuli.

Burning Water, with a
purge, will also cure
these diseases.

These medicines put
away wicked thoughts,
and bring in merry
ones; they dispel
devils' temptations and
despair, and bring a
man to reason.

‘Saturne. γ.’
Saturn is an enemy to
all creatures, and has

enemye to al kynde / Forwhy, euery
snow, euery hayl, euery tempest, &
also þe humour of malencoly comeþ of
him. & he haþ his influence vpon derk
leed, &

power over foul
solitary places, as Vitas
Patrum says.

[* Fol. 21b.]

vpon derk *placis vnder þe erf¹¹, foule
and stynkyng, and derke wodis, and
vpon foule, horrible, solitarie placis, as
it is preued in *vitas patrum*, þat is to
seye, in lyues & colaciouns of fadris /
And also þe moone, naturely coold and
moist, haþ his influence vpon þe nyzt,
and vpon myche moisture, and vpon
þe placis whanne 4. weyes metiþ
togidere. forsoþe in alle sicke placis
þei wole a-bide and schewe hem to her
followeris /

The Moon too is full of
bane.

but forsoþe þo þingis þat ben of þe
nature of Iubiter and of sol, goode
planetis, arne displesynge to him, and
contrarie, and naturally deuellis fle awei
fro hem, for þei haue greet
abhominacioun of þer vertuous
influence /

‘Jubiter and Sol |
.B.’

Jupiter and Sol, on the
other hand, make
devils flee,

þerfore it schewiþ weel þat þo þingis
þat ben in þis world, summe þer ben
þat bitokene þe glorious yoie of
heuene, and summe þing þat figure þe
derknesse of euerlastynge peynes of
helle / Forsoþe þe sunne and iubiter,
goode planetis, & gold, pure metal,
and alle pure þingis þat gladen a man,
figuryng by resoun þe ioie of heuene /
and blak Saturne, and þe spotty
moone, figure & bitokene þe

and betoken the joy of
heaven,

as Saturn and the
Moon do hell.

TO CURE THE
GOUT AND
ITCH, AND
KILL LICE.

condicioun of helle /

and siþ þat deuelis be dampned, & ful
of wreche of helle, þerfore þei hate þe
clennesse & þe ioie of oure lord god &
of hise seyntis / also þei haten þe
sunne and his cleernes, and pure þingis
þat maken a man glad. and naturaly it
plesip hem to dwelle in derk, & in
blak, horrible, stynkyng placis, in
heuynesse, wreche, & malencoly, & in
þo þingis þat pretende þe condicioun
of helle /

[* Fol. 22.]

And siþ oure 5. essence aforeseid is so
heuenly a þing, & by sotil craft
*brouzt to so myche swetnes, it is so
souereyn a medicyn þat it may weel be
lijkned to þe ioie of *paradice*. forwhi,
it makip a man lizt, iocunde, glad, and
merie, & puttip away heuynesse¹²,
angre, melencoly, & wrapþe, þe
whiche þat deuelis loue / **et ideo
nostra 5 essencia digne vocatur
celum humanum** /

Also if a man be traueylid wip a feend,
and may not be delyuerid fro him, lete
him drinke a litil quantite of oure 5
essence, wip 5 essence of gold &
peerl, and wip an eerbe callid
ypericon, i.[e.] *fuga demonum*, and þe
seed þerof grounden & aftirward
distillid, & þe watir þerof a litil
quantite medlid wip þe opere 5^{tis}
essenciis; and anoon þe deuel wole fle
away fro him & fro his hous.

Devils hate the joys of
God and the brightness
of the sun; they delight
in stinking places, and
melancholy and hell-
like things.

But our Quinte Essence
is heavenly, like the joy
of Paradise, and drives
away anger and all that
devils love, so that it is
fitly called ‘Man’s
Heaven.’

To deliver a man from
a devil,—give him
some of our Quinte
Essence with that of
gold and pearl, and St.
John’s Wort water: at
once the devil will flee
away.

‘fuga demonum’

Also for þe goute, hoot or cold, þe
pacient schal drynke oure 5. essence
wip a litil *quantite* at oonys of þe
letuarie de succo rosarum. and lete him
vse þis letuarie a litil at oonys ech
opere day, til superflue humouris be
purgid / but he schal vse euery day a
litil of oure 5. essence with 5 essence
of gold & peerle; & wipinne a fewe
dayes þe pacient schal be hool. //

The .7. medicyn, for to heele ycche, &
for to distrie lies¹³ þat ben engendrid
of corrupt humouris. take oure 5
essence bi him silf a-loone, and vse to
drynke þerof a litil quantite at oonys /
and take also a litil *quantite* of
Mer[curie?]. & mortifie it wip
fastynge spotil, & medle it wip a good
quantite of poudre of stafi-sagre, &
þanne put it in to a greet *quantite* of
brennyng water,

[* Fol. 22b.]

& þanne waische al his body, or ellis
þe heed where þe icche & þe lies ben.
& vse þis medicyn .2. or 3. & þe sijk
*man schal be hool.

TO CURE
QUARTAN
FEVER.

The .8. medicyn for to cure the
quarteyn and alle þe passiouns þat
comeþ of malencoly in mannys body;
and þe maistrie to purge malencoly.
and 3e schal vndirstonde þat þe
quarteyn is gendrid of myche
haboundaunce of malencolye þat is
corrumpid *withynne* þe body. and for

To cure the Gout.

Take a little Quinte
Essence and Rose-juice
electuary, and use daily
our Quinte Essence
with that of Gold and
Pearl.

‘.7. M^e.’

To cure the Itch and
destroy Lice.

Drink Quinte Essence.
Mix Mercury with
spittle, Stavesacre and
Burning Water.

Wash the body or head
where the itch and lice
are.

‘.8^{ua}. M^e.’

‘feuer quartene.’

To cure Quartan Fever.

‘ye quarten is
ingendyrd of
Malyncoly.’

þis humour is erþely, coold, & drie, of
þe nature of slowe saturne, þerfore þe
accesse of þis sjuknes ben slowe, and it
durip comounly yn a man a 3eer or
more, and it puttþ fro him gladnesse,
& bryngþ yn heuynes more þan oþere
feueris do /

If 3e wole heele þis sjuknes in schort
tyme, lete þe pacient vse to drynke
oon¹⁴ 5 essence, and he schal be al
hool hastily / forwhi; it consumeþ þe
corrupt superflue humouris, & reducit
nature to equalite, and bryngþ yn
gladnesse, & chasþ a-wey heuynes &
malencolie.

and if it so be þat 3e haue nouzt oure 5
essence / þanne take j 15 of þe beste
brennyng watir, and þerinne putte
medullam ebuli, and namely þe white,
if 3e may may haue it / of þis watir
3eue to þe pacient, morowe and euen, a
walnot-schelle ful at oonys. and he
schal be al hool /

or ellis þus: take what þing 3e wole þat
purgþ malencolye, and putte a litil
þerof into brennyng watir, & vse þat
laxatif maad into smale pelotis, wijsly
resceyuyng ri3t a litil at oonys, as oon
litil pellet, and preue þerby how it
worchip, þanne anoþer tyme .ij. at
oonys, if it be nede / so þat þe mater be
a litil digestid and a litil egestid. for
bettere it is to worche a litil & a litil at
oonys, þan sodeynly greue þe nature.

The Quartan arises
from too much black
choler, and lasts a year
or more.

To cure it soon, drink
our Quinte Essence;

if you have it not, put
pith of white dwarf
elder in Burning Water,
and take a walnut-shell
full morning and
evening.

Or, take whatever
purges black choler,
put it into Burning
Water; make small
pellets of it, and take
one, and then two,
gradually.

[* Fol. 23.]

forwhi, two litil pelotis laxatif
meyngid wiþ brennynge watir *wole
worche more myztily þan .8. pelotis
wole do bi hem silf /

Also philosophoris seyn þat a tootþ
drawe out from a quyk beest, born
vpon a man, delyueriþ fro þe
quarteyn / Also þei seyn þat if þe yuis
of þe eerbe þat is callid morsus galline
rubri be putt in hise nose-þrillis
whanne he bigynneth to suffre þe
accesse of þe quarteyn, he schal be
hool, wiþ þe grace of god.

‘Nota for y^e
quartene.’

It is said that a tooth
from a live beast heals
the Quartan, and the
juice of Hen-bit or
Chickweed put in a
man’s nostrils.

TO CURE
CONTINUAL,
TERTIAN AND
DAILY FEVERS.

The medicyn to heele þe feuere
contynuele. alle philosophoris seyn þat
þe feuere contynuele is gendrid of
putrifaccioun of blood and of
corrupcieun of humouris in it / þerfore
þe cure þerof is to purge blood, and to
putte away þe corrupcioun of it, & þe
humoris vneueene to make euene, þe
nature lost to restore, and so restorid to
kepe /

Forsoþe alle þese þingis worcheþ oure
quinte essence; and þerfore it curiþ
perfiȝtly þe feuere contynuele / and
þouȝ brennynge watir caste out fro
blood watry humouris and corrupt, ȝitt
take it nouȝt in þis cure / forwhi; þouȝ
brennynge watir be .7. tymes distillid,
ȝitt it is [not] fully depurid fro his
brennynge heete, & þe .4. elementis /
but siþ oure 5. essence is not hoot, ne

‘9^a. M^e.’

To cure continual
Fever.

It arises from
putrefaction of blood
and corruptions of
humours.

Our Quinte Essence
cures this, (tho’
Burning Water does
not,)

moist, coold, ne drie, as ben þe 4.
elementis /

þerfore it heelþ perfiztly þe contynuel
feuere; namely wiþ commixtioun of þe
5 essence of gold & peerle / and if 3e
wole strenkþe 3oure medicyn, þanne
putte yn oure 5. essence a litil quantite
of pulpa cassie fistule / or ellis þe iuys
of þe eerbe mercuriale.

[* Fol. 23b.]

& if it so be þat oþere humouris
habounde to myche *with* blood, þanne
take þo laxatyues þat kyndely wole
*purge hem, as comoun bookis of fisik
declareþ.

The 10. medicyn to cure þe feuere
tercian, þe which is causid of
putrifaccioun, or reed coler to myche
haboundynge / to cure þees sijknys, tak
oure 5 essence, or ellis fyn brennynge
watir,—but þe firste is bettere,—and
putte þerinne a litil of rubarbe or of
summe oþer laxatiue þat purgip reed
coler, and a greet quantite of watir of
endyue; and vse þis medicyn at
morowe & euen. and þe pacient schal
be hool wiþoute doute.

The 11. medicyn is for to heele þe
feuere cotidian, þe which is causid of
putrifaccioun of flewme to
haboundynge / and siþ flewme is coold
and moist. oure 5 essence (and in his
absence take good brennynge watir.)
hap strenkþe and vertu to consume þe

if mixed with Quinte
Essence of Gold and
Pearl,
and a little Cassia or
Herb Mercury.

‘10. M^e.’

‘feuer tercyane.’

To cure Tertian Fever.

Take Quinte Essence,
with Rhubarb and
Endive water, morn
and eve.

‘water of endyue.’

‘.11. M^e.’

‘feuer cotydyan.’

To cure Daily Fever.

rotun watery inordinat, and to myche
coold humidite /

þerfore take oure 5 essence or
brennynge watir, and putte þerinne a
litol of euforbij, turbit, or sambuci, or
sum opir þing þat purgiþ flewme; and
vse it morowe and eue, & þe pacient
schal be hool.

Take our Quinte
Essence, and a little
Euphorbium, &c.

TO CURE AGUE
FEVER,
LUNACY, AND
CRAMP.

The .12. medicyn for to cure þe feuere
agu, and þe lunatik man and
womman / discreet maistris seyn, þat
þe feuere agu comounly is causid of a
uyolent reed coler adust, and of blood
adust, and of blak coler adust; and
sumtyme of oon of þese adust, and
sumtyme of two togidere, and
sumtyme of .3. togidere /

and þerfore þe feuere agu is þe
posityue degree, and in þe superlatyue
degree, comparatif gree & superlatif
gree / For þe feuere agu haþ comounly
alienacioun of witt, & schewynge of
þingis of fantasy /

‘.12. M^e.’

*To cure Ague Fever
and Lunacy.*

‘lunatyke persons.’
This fever comes of
choler inflamed,

and is accompanied by
lightheadedness.

[* Fol. 24.]

And 3e schal knowe weel whiche ben
þe humouris adust þat causen þe
feuere, be þese *tokenes / Forwhi, if
þe pacient seiþ þat he seep blak þingis,
þanne blak coler, þat is, malencolie, is
adust / & if he se þingis of gold / reed
coler is adust / if reed þingis, and
schewynge of bloodt þanne blood is
adust / And if he seiþ þat he seep alle
þese .iij. þingis, þanne alle þe
humouris ben adust / For as myche as

‘Nota bene.’

‘Signa.’

As the patient sees
black, gold, or red
things, so the different
humours are inflamed.

brennyng watir ascendib to þe heed,
and gladly wole a man drynke /

And siþ þat feure agu regneb in þe
regioun of þe heed / þe philosophoris
counceilis þat þe pacient schal not
resceyue it in þis sijknes /

but it is nedeful þat he take oure 5
essence of gold and of peerl, meynging
þe 6 part of 5 essence of watir of rose,
violet, borage, and letuse¹⁵ / and
þanne 3e schulen haue an heuenly
medicyn to cure perfiztly þis sijknesse.

Burning Water should
not be taken,

but Quinte Essence of
Gold and Pearl should,
with that of Rose
water, Violet, &c.

For to cure þe frenesye and woodnes,
or ellis at þe leeste to swage it / take a
greet quantite of popilion, and þe beste
vynegre þat 3e may haue, and a good
quantite of rewe domestik, weel
brayed, and meyngid wiþ þese forseid
þingis;

and biclippe þe heed and þe feet of þe
pacient *with* þis medicyn; and sum
þerof putte to his nose-þrillis. þis
medicyn anoon puttiþ away þe
frenesye & þe schewynge of fantasies /
it curiþ also wode men & lunatike
men. and it restoriþ azen witt and
discrecioun, & makip al hool and weel
at eese.

‘for y^e frenesye &
wodnesse.’

To cure or assuage
Frenzy and Madness.

Wrap the head and feet
in, and smell at,
Popilion (with Vinegar
mixed), and Rue.

[* Fol. 24b.]

The .13. medicyn is to put a-wey þe
craumpe fro a man. for as myche as
wise men seyn þat þe craumpe cometh
of þe hurtyng & þe febilnes of þe
senewis, as it schewiþ sumtyme yn

‘13^a. M^e.’

To cure Cramp.

Use our Quinte
Essence or Burning
Water.

medicyns maad of elebore, þer is no
þing þat puttþ away þe craumpe as
doiþ oure 5 essence aforeseid, or ellis
*brennynge watir in stede of it.

TO CURE
POISON AND
COWARDICE.

The .14. medicyn, to caste out venym
fro mannys body / take oure 5 essence,
and putte þerine fleisch of a cok,
neysch soden & sotilly brayed, note
kirnelis, fyn triacle, radisch, & garleek
smal brayed, and opere þingis þat ben
goode to caste out venym, as comoun
bookis of fisik declarþ / And also, to
comforte þe herte, putte yn oure
foreseid 5. essence, þe 5. essence of
gold and of peerl. and he schal be
delyuerid þerof & be hool.

The .15. medicyn, to make a man þat
is a coward, hardy and strong, and
putte a-wey almaner of cowardise and
drede / I seye 3ou forsoþe þat no þing
may telle alle þe myraclis vertues þat
god haþ maad in oure 5 essence, and
not al oonly in him, but also in to his
modir, þat is to seye, fyn brennynge
watir.

for to cure þis sjuknesse, take a litil
quantite of oure 5 essence, & putte
þerto double so myche of brennynge
watir, and a litil quantite of þe iuys of
eerbe pione and of saffron distillid
togidere, and a litil of 5 essence of
gold and of peerl; and 3eue it him to
drinke. and aftir sodeynly, as it were

‘14^a. M^e.’

*To cast poison out of a
man's body.*

Take our Quinte
Essence, with cock's
flesh, nut-kernels, &c.,
and Quinte Essence of
Gold and Pearls.

‘15a. M^e.’

*To make a Coward
bold and strong.*

Give him our Quinte
Essence with twice as
much Burning Water,
and a little Peony juice
and saffron, and Quinte
Essence of Gold and
Pearl. The coward shall
lose all faintness of
heart, despise death,
and dread no perils.

by myracle, þe coward man schal lese
 al maner drede and feyntnes of herte,
 and he schal recouere strenkþe þat ys
 lost by drede, and take to him
 hardynesse, and he schal dispise deepþ;
 he schal drede no perelis, and
 passyngly he schal be maad hardy. þis
 is trewe, for it hap ofte tymes by oolde
 philosophoris [bene] preued /

[* Fol. 25.]

þerfore it were a greet wisdom þat
 cristen princis, in bateilis azen heþene
 men, hadde wiþ hem in tonnes
 brennyng watir, þat þei myȝt take to
 euery fiztyng man half a riȝt litil
 cuppe ful þerof to drynke in þe
 bigynnyng of þe batel. & þis priuyte
 owith to be hid from alle enemyes of
 þe chirche; and also *princis and
 lordis ministringe þese þingis schulde
 not telle what it is.

Therefore Christian
 Princes should have
 tuns of Burning Water,
 and give every fighting
 man a cup before battle
 with the heathen.

TO CURE
 PESTILENTIAL
 FEVER AND
 PLAGUES.

The .16. medicyn azens þe feuere
 pestilenciale, and þe maistrie to cure it.
 forsoþe holy scripture seiþ þat summe
 tymes oure lord god sendiþ pestilence
 to sle summe maner of peple, as it is
 seid deutronomium 28 in þis maner
 “Si audire nolueris¹⁶ vocem domini
 dei tui, ut custodias *et* facias omnia
 mandata eius, veniant super te omnes
 maledicciones; iste maledictus eris in
 ciuitate &c.” *et* infra; “ad-iungat tibi
 pestilenciam donec consumat te de
 terra, percuciat te dominus egestate,
 febre, *et* frigore, ardore *et* estu, *et* aere

‘16^a. M^e.’

To cure Pestilential
 Fever (when not sent
 as a punishment by
 God).

God says in
 Deuteronomy xxviii.
 that if men will not
 hear His voice and
 obey His
 commandments,
 pestilences shall come
 on them.

corrupto ac rubigine, *et persequatur
donec pereas*” hec *ibidem*; *et infra*
“percuciat te dominus vlcere egipti, et
partem corporis per quam stercora
egerantur. scabie quoque, et prurigine,
ita ut curari nequeas; percuciat te
dominus necessitate ac furore
mentis” //

Therefore a gret fool were he þat wolde
presume to cure þese plagis of
pestilence þat ben vncurable, þat ben
sent of god to ponysche synne // Also
3e schal vndirstonde þat men may die
in .iiij. maners. in oon maner by naturel
deeph, in þe teerme þat is sett of god /
In anopir maner bi violent deep, and
also in þe .iiij. maner occasionally
wiþinne þe teerme þat is sett of god; as
þo men þat to myche replecioun, or to
greet abstynence or by disperacioun,
or ellis by negligence, sle him silf /
but sikirly alle opere maner of feueris
pestilence þat god suffriþ to come to
mankynde by perilous influence of
yuele planetis, by þe grace of god &
good gouernaunce may be curid
partialy wiþ oure 5. essence.

[* Fol. 25b.]

and þerinne putte a litil of aloes epatik
& euforbij, & a litil of ierapigra galieni
& of 5 essence, of þe rote of lilie and
also of gold & peerle, capilli veneris
*and ysope; for þese þingis ben
nedeful to siche feueris & apostemes /
it is nedeful also þat wiþ þese þingis
þer be sich a quinta essencia laxatyue

These plagues a man
would be a great fool
to presume to cure,

but all other pestilences
from evil planets may
be cured by our Quinte
Essence with Aloes,
Euphorbium, &c.,

‘Nota bene.’

and a laxative Quinte
Essence that will send

þat wole purge þe superflue humouris
þat abounde; and þat þe pacient so
myche resceyue in a natural day þerof
þat he may go weel oonys to sege; and
so lete him vse þis laxatif .3. in þe
woke;

But be weel war þat he take wiþ oure
quinta essencia but riȝt a litil *quantite*
of þe laxatif at oonys, as I tolde ȝou
tofore, for peril þat miȝte bifalle.

& euery day take he by þe morowe an
eye-schelle ful of good brennynge
watir, and þe corrupt eyr schal not
noye him; & also vse in þe dayes, two
or þre smale pelotis pestilenciales in
oure 5 essencia, or in brennynge watir;
& al þe hous of þe pacient schal be
encensid strongly .iij. in þe day wiþ
frank-encense, mirre, & rosyn,
terbentyn & rewe.

and þis is *perfiȝt* cure for þe feuere
pestilence / And þus ȝe may, wiþ þis 5
essencijs, cure alle þese sijknesses
aforeseid, and manye oþere, as it were
by miracle, if ȝe worche disc[r]eetly
as I haue toold ȝou tofore /

Now here I make an eende of þis tretis
þat is clepid þe mooste & þe
souereyneste secrete of alle secretis,
and a passynge tresour þat may nouȝt
fayle //

O quantum malum foret, si hic liber
perueniret ad manus hominum
mundanorum, ad *noticiam tyrannorum*,
et ad seruicium reproborum! quia,

the patient to stool
once a day.

‘Caueas.’

He must also take
every morning an egg-
shell-full of Burning
Water, and 2 or 3
pestilence pills in our
Quinte Essence, and
smoke his house with
frankincense, &c.

Here is an end of this
most sovereign of all
secrets.

What ills will befall if
it gets into tyrants’ and
reprobates’ hands and
prolongs their life in
evil. I will keep it for
holy men alone; and I

MAY THIS
BOOK...

sicut *sancti* per hunc librum poterunt
continuatione opera vite *christiani*
diucius et vehemencius, ita et reprobi
possent peruerso vsi diucius
perseuerare in malo. ego autem,
quantum in me est, propter solos
sanctos librum hunc constituo, et
ipsum custod[iæ] ihesu *Christi*
commendo nunc et in eternum //==//

commend it to Christ's
keeping now and ever.

Explicit librum de maximis secretis essencie quinte &c.

FOOTNOTES

1. practise, MS. Harl.
original text.

Printed as a sidenote in the

2. ? MS. meant for 'man.'

3. MS. 'siff.'

4. then, MS. Harl.

Printed as sidenote.

5. 5 for *fifth*, or *quinte*.

6. MS. Harl. reads 'and this fite beinge so nighe kinde
it is most to haue.'

7. of vnkinde natuer. Harl. 853.

8. of glasse made. Harl. 853.

9. ? 'be so hool.' Or is *hool* a verb, become whole,
recover?

10. MS. hom

Printed as sidenote.

11. Erf = erþe.

12. houynesse MS.

13. “A lous is a worme *with* manye fete, & it commeth out of the filthi and onclene skynne, & oftentimes for faute of atendaunce they come out of the flesshe through the skynne or swet holes.

To withdryue them / The best is for to wasshe the oftentimes, and to chaunge oftentimes clene linnen.”—
The noble lyfe and nature of man, Of bestes, serpentys, fowles, and fisshes y^t be moste knowen. Capitulo. C. xix.

14. ? our

Printed as sidenote.

15. *in margin*, ‘Rose / violett / Borage / lutuse /’

Printed in the space at the end of its paragraph ([page image](#)): may have been intended for a sidenote.

16. MS. volueris.

THE SPHERES AND PLANETS

[leaf 26]

¶ Philosophirs puttyn 9 speris vndirewritten; but Diuinis puttyn þe tenþe spere, where is heuyn empire, in þe whiche, angelis & sowlis¹ of seyntis seruen god; in þe whiche is crist, in þe same forme that he walkid in erþe, and also owre lady, & seyntis that arosen *with* criste.

¶ Þe first spere of þe 9 is clepid ‘*primum mobile*,’ þe first mevabil thyng.

¶ Þe .ij. spere of sterris: Aries .1. þe rame. ¶ the secund hows of Mars, þe bool, ¶ þe secund hows of Venus, Gemini, ¶ þe secund hows of Mercuri, Cancer. ¶ þe hows of þe mone, leo. þe hows of þe sonne, Virgo. // þe first hows of Mercury, Libra // þe first hows of Venus, Scorpio // þe first hows of Mars, Sagittarius // þe first hows of Iubiter, Capricornus // þe first hows of Saturne, Aquarius // þe secund hows of Saturne, Piscis. / þe secunde hows of Iubiter

[no more].

¶ Saturn is a planete evel-willid and ful of sekenes. Wherefore he is peyntid with an hooke, for he repeþ dow{n} grene thyngis / he fulfillip his course in xxx 3eere.

¶ Iubiter is a planete wele willyng to alle thingis to be gendrid, plent[i]ful & plesyng; therfor he is y-seid Iubiter as helpyn. in xij [3]eere he fillip his course.

¶ Mars is an enemy to alle thyngis to be gendrid; wherfor he is clepid god of batel, for he is ful of tempest. he fulfillip his course in .ij. 3eere.
[leaf 26, back]

¶ Þe sonne is þe worthiest planet, y-set in myddis. he fulfillip his course in CCClxv dayes & vj. howris, þe whiche causen bisext.

¶ Venus is apte to alle thyngis to be gendrid. he fulfillip his course in CCCxxxvj daies.

¶ Mercuri swyft is y-seid a messenger of daies [? heuene]. he fulfillip his course in CCCxxxvj daies.

¶ Þe mone is a planete ny þe erþe.

[ends.]

1. *lis* is the MS. l with a line at right angles to it.

NOTES

ON THE CHEMISTRY OF THE TEXT

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[P. 4.](#) Direction to submit any wine *that is not sour* to distillation. (*Sour* wine is deficient in alcohol; that body having been changed into acetic acid by oxidation.) In the language of the mystical ideas which prevailed in the dawn of Chemistry, the colouring matters, sugar, &c. of the wine are called ‘the .4. elementis,’ or as it were the ‘rotten fæces of wine’??

The direction to distill the wine seven times is a good practical suggestion for the obtaining of strong alcohol which will burn well. Then follows a description of the distilling apparatus, which seems to have been arranged to ensure a very slow distillation, so as to obtain a product as colourless and scentless as possible.

[P. 5.](#) The second way to make the Quinte essence depends on distillation of alcohol by means of the heat of fermenting horse-dung; also the fifth manner.

[P. 6.](#) The directions for gilding burning water are all nonsense; but as the writer had no means of testing the truth of his statements, they may have been made in good faith.

[P. 7.](#) The idea which he expresses, that this gilt burning water will make you well and young, is difficult to explain, except on the assumption that, it being the strongest of alcohol, a very little served to produce that elevation of spirits which seemed to bring back the spring of youth.

[P. 7.](#) l. 6 from the bottom. The word *liquibles* in the text does not mean liquids, for a liquid cannot be made hot enough to be *quenched*. If the original *liquibles* cannot be retained I should substitute the word *liquiables*, meaning those things which can be liquefied by heat. Indeed in the next passage we find stated that if Saturn (the alchemists' mystical name for Lead) be quenched, &c., and that if then Mars (Iron) be quenched in the same liquid, it will acquire the softness of Saturn. Or if you quench lead in spirit which has had iron first cooled in it, it becomes hard.

Of course there is no truth whatever in the above statements.

[P. 8.](#) The fire without coals, &c., is 'corrosive sublimate,' most probably containing an excess of Sulphuric acid (vitriol) as an impurity. If Copper (Venus) or Tin (Jupiter) be dipt into this solution of mercury they will have a deposit of mercury formed on their surface, which will give them a pearly appearance.

[P. 8.](#) To bring Gold into calx. When gold is treated in the way directed, a fine powder of gold of a brown or yellow colour is left. This might readily

have been mistaken for a calx by those who had no clear ideas of what calx really was.

[P. 9.](#) The departing of gold from silver is essentially the same as the plan practised at the present day.

To get the Quintessence of Gold. I can make nothing of the directions, that is, I cannot see that they (the directions) hide any real truth.

[P. 10.](#) How to get the Quintessence of Antimony. I can make nothing of this part, and can only suggest that the vinegar used contained hydrochloric acid, and when distilled with 'Myn Antimony' (native sulphide of antimony) gave a distillate of Chloride of Antimony containing some 'kermes' which is red.

From this point onward there is little or nothing that can be explained by a Chemist.

GLOSSARY.

[Agu](#), p. 22, l. 1, 'Intermittent Fever, commonly called an *Ague*, has certain times of Intermission or ceasing; it begins for the most part with Cold or Shivering, ends in Heat, and returns exactly at set Periods.' *Phillips*.

[Aischin](#), p. 4, l. 10, ashes.

[Amphora](#), p. 11, &c., 'a large vessel which derived its name from its being made with a handle on each side of the neck, from ἀμφί *on both sides*, and φέρω *I carry*.' *Dict. of Gr. and Rom. Ant.*

[Anele](#), p. 6, l. 26, &c., heat?

[Apostemes](#), p. 24, l. 24, imposthumes, boils.

[Appeire](#), p. 3, l. 12, impair, worsen.

[Arreins](#), p. 2, l. 25, spiders.

'[Cassia Fistula](#) (Lat.), Cassia in the Pipe or Cane, a kind of Reed or Shrub that grows in *India* and *Africa*, bearing

[Marien Bath](#), p. 12, l. 7 bot., Balneum Mariæ, a Chemist's bath. '*Bain de Marie*. Maries bath; a cauldron, or kettle full of hot water.' *Cotgrave*.

[Medle](#), p. 19 last line, mix.

[Medulla](#), p. 18, l. 3, pith.

[Mercasite](#), p. 10, l. 14, 'a kind of Mineral Stone, hard and brittle, partaking of the Nature and Colour of the Metal it is mixed with; some call it a Fire-Stone.' *Phillips*.

[Mercuriale](#), mercurie, p. 21, 19, &c., 'Mercury .. among Chymists .. signifies Quick-silver; and is also taken for one of their active Principles, commonly call'd *Spirit* .. Also the Name of a purging Herb, of which there are two sorts, viz. *Good Harry* and *Dog's Mercury*.'

[Metis](#), p. 16, l. 22, *meatus*, passages.

[Mon](#), p. 13, l. 19. ?

black, round, and long Cods, in which is contain'd a soft black Substance, sweet like Honey, and of a purging Quality.' *Phillips*.

[Colaciouns](#), p. 18, l. 21, ? comments, homilies.

[Comounne](#), p. 3, l. 35, communicate.

'[Continual Feaver](#) is that whose Fit is continu'd for many Days; having its times of Abatement, and of more Fierceness; altho' it never intermits, or leaves off.' *Phillips*.

[Deedly](#), p. 3, l. 24, liable to death, mortal.

[Departynge](#), p. 5, l. 14, parting, separating.

[Depurid](#), p. 9, l. 27, purified, purged.

[Distillatorie](#), p. 10, l. 24, a still. Randle Holme, (*Academy*, p. 422, col. 2,) speaks of 'a Still or Distillatory Instrument,' and further on, iv., 'He beareth Sable, the Head of a *Distillatory* with 3 pipes; having as many Receivers or Bottles set to them.'

'[Ebulum](#) or Ebulus (Lat.), the Herb *Wall-wort*, *Dane-wort*, or *Dwarf-elder*.' *Phillips*.

[Encorpere](#), p. 13, l. 4, mix, incorporate.

[Euforbii](#), p. 21, l. 3 bot., 'Euphorbia, the *Libyan Ferula*, a Tree or Shrub first found by King *Juba*, and so call'd from the Name of his Physician *Euphorbus*.' *Phillips*.

Euphorbium, 'the gummy Juice or Sap of that Tree much us'd in Physick and Surgery.' *Phillips*.

[Extremities](#), p. 17, l. 2, ends of the limbs.

[Fecis](#), p. 4, l. 7; p. 9, dregs.

[Fire of hell](#), p. 8, l. 23, a disease.

[Fumiter](#), p. 18, l. 3, fumitory.

[Fyme](#), p. 10, l. 2 bot., mud, clay.

[Gerapigra galieni](#), p. 3, l. 29, ἱερὰ πικρὰ Γάληνου.

[Giltid](#), p. 7, l. 3, having the properties of gold communicated by it.

[Morsus Gallinæ](#), the Herb Henbit or Chick-weed. *Phillips*.

[Mortifie](#), p. 19 last line, 'Among Chymists to change the outward Form or Shape of a Mixt Body; as when Quicksilver, or any other Metal, is dissolved in an *acid Menstruum*.' *Phillips*.

[Neischede](#), p. 7, l. 2 bot., neshness, softness, pliancy.

[Oo](#), p. 4, one.

[Popilion](#), p. 22, l. 24; 'Populeum, an Ointment made of Poplar buds, of a cooling and allaying Quality.' *Phillips*. Fr. '*Populeon*. Popilion, a Pompillion; an ointment made of blacke Poplar buds.' *Cot*.

[Preparate](#), p. 8, l. 21, prepare.

'[Quartan](#) Ague is that whose Fit returns every fourth Day.' *Phillips*.

[Quenchour](#), p. 6 at foot, cooling the florin? Quintessence is defined by Phillips as 'the purest Substance drawn out of any Natural Body; a Medicine made of the efficacious active Particles of its Ingredients separated from all *Fæces* or Dregs; the Spirit, chief Force, or Virtue of any thing.'

[Reme](#), p. 9, l. 5 bot., A.S. *reoma*, a strap, thong.

[Reparale](#), p. 8, l. 21, make, compound.

[Respire](#), p. 4, l. 5 from foot, exhale.

[Restreyne](#), p. 7, l. 8, retain.

[Reward](#), p. 2, l. 4, 7, regard.

[Rotombe](#), p. 10, l. 3 bot., a retort.

[Sambucy](#), p. 16, l. 7 bot., 'Sambucus, the Elder-Tree; a Shrub of very great use in Physic.' *Phillips*.

[Stafisagre](#), p. 20, l. 1, 'Staphis agria, the Herb Staves-acre, or Lice-bane.' *Phillips*.

'[Tertian](#) Ague or Feaver is that which intermits entirely, and returns again every third Day with its several Symptoms at a set Time.' *Phillips*.

[To](#), p. 1, l. 16, too.

[Groste](#), p. 5, ll. 9, 29, grossness, heavy particles, residuum.

[Hide](#), p. 13, l. 18, ? for hideus; compare the Harleian reading 'unkinde.'

[Hool](#), p. 15, l. 10, recover, improve.

[Incombustible](#), p. 10, l. 2.

[Incorruptibility](#), p. 7, l. 2.

[Kynde](#), p. 1, l. 12, all creatures; l. 13, nature.

'[Lapis Lazuli](#) a kind of Azure or Sky-colour'd Stone, of which the Blew Colour call'd *Ultramarine* is made .. much us'd in Physick.' *Phillips*.

[Lembike](#), p. 9, l. 2, 'Alembick or Limbeck (Arab.), a Still, a Chymical Vessel used in Distilling, shaped like a Helmet, and towards the Bottom having a Beak or Nose, about a Foot and a half long, by which the Vapours descend. They are commonly made of Copper tinn'd over on the inside, and often of Glass.' *Phillips*.

[Liquibles](#), p. 7, l. 6 bot., meltable metals.

[Lymayl](#), p. 8, l. 6 bot., Fr. '*limaille*: f. File-dust, pinne-dust.' *Cotgrave*.

[Triacle](#), p. 23, l. 5, cordial, 'Treacle, a Physical Composition, made of Vipers and other Ingredients.' *Phillips*.

[Turbit](#), p. 16, l. 7 bot., 'Turbit, Tripoly, an Herb called Turbith, or blew Camomel.'

'Turbith, an Herb so call'd by the Arabians, which grows in Cambaya, Surat, and other parts of Asia; a dangerous Drug upon account of its violent purging Quality.' *Phillips*.

[Vapoure](#), p. 8, l. 5 from foot; p. 9 at foot, evaporate.

[Woodnes](#), p. 22, l. 23, wildness, madness.

[Ypericon](#), p. 19, l. 16, 'Hypericon, St. *John's-Wort*, an excellent Herb for Wounds, and to provoke Urine.' *Phillips*.

Errata and Technical Notes

The character “l-bar” † (html entity #410 or x019A) has been represented in this text by “l-stroke” † (#322 or x0142), as it is much more widely available.

Two entries in the Table of Contents were merged in the printed book, apparently for reasons of space. The original form was:

HOW TO CURE FRENSY, GOUT, AND TROUBLES FROM	19
DEVILS, WICKED THOUGHTS, ETC., p. 17; AND HOW OUR	
QUINTE ESSENCE IS HEAVEN	

See also comments on footnotes, especially [Footnote 15](#) with linked page image.

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'12. M.'

'Isotipke
prousa.'
To cure Ague
Fever and
Lunacy.

This fever
comes of choler
inflamed.

and is accom-
panied by
lightheaded-
ness.

'Nota bene.'

['* Fol. 24.]

'Signa.'
As the patient
sees black,
gold, or red
things, so the
different hu-
mours are in-
flamed.

Burning
Water should
not be taken.

but Quinte
Essence of
Gold and
Pearl should,
with that of
Rose water,
Violet, &c.

'for ye fren-
zye & wode-
ness.'

To cure or dis-
cuss Frenzy
and Madness.

Wrap the
head and feet
in, and smell
at, Popilion
(with Vinegar
mixed), and
Rose.

'13. M.'

To cure
Cramp.

Use our
Quinte Es-
sence or
Burning
Water.

The .12. medicyn for to cure þe feure agu, and þe lunatik
man and womman / discreet maistris seyn, þat þe feure
agu comounly is causid of a yolent reed coler adust, and of
blood adust, and of blak coler adust; and sumtyme of oon of 4
þese adust, and sumtyme of two togidere, and sumtyme of .3.
togidere / and þerfore þe feure agu is þe posityue degree, and
in þe superlatyue degree, comparatif gree & superlatif gree /
For þe feure agu hap comounly alienacioun of witt, & schew- 8
ynge of þingis of fantasy / And 3e schal knowe weel whiche
ben þe humouris adust þat causen þe feure, be þese *tokenes /
Forwhi, if þe pacient seiþ þat he seiþ blak þingis, þanne blak
coler, þat is, malencolie, is adust / & if he se þingis of gold / 12
reed coler is adust / if reed þingis, and schewynge of bloodt
þanne blood is adust / And if he seiþ þat he seiþ alle þese .iiij,
þingis, þanne alle þe humouris ben adust / For as myche as
brennyng watir ascendip to þe heed, and gladly wole a man 16
drynke / And siþ þat feure agu regneþ in þe regioun of þe
heed / þe philosophis counsellis þat þe pacient schal not
resceyue it in þis sijkes / but it is nedeful þat he take
oure 5 essence of gold and of pearl, meynge þe 6 part of 20
5 essence of watir of rose, violet, borage, and letuse¹ / and
þanne 3e schulen haue an heuenly medicyn to cure perfittly þis
sijknesse. [1 in margin, 'Rose / violett / Borage / lutuse /']

For to cure þe frenesye and woodnes, or ellis at þe leeste 24
to swage it / take a greet quantite of popilion, and þe beste
vynegre þat 3e may haue, and a good quantite of rewe domestik,
weel brayed, and meynge wip þese forseid þingis; and biclippe
þe heed and þe feet of þe pacient wif þis medicyn; and sum 28
þerof putte to his noseþrillis. þis medicyn anon puttip away þe
frenesye & þe schewynge of fantasies / it curip also wode men
& lunatike men. and it restorip aȝen witt and discrecioun, &
makip al hool and weel at cese. 32

The .13. medicyn is to put a-wey þe craumpe fro a man.
for as myche as wise men seyn þat þe craumpe cometh of þe
hurtyng & þe febilnes of þe senewis, as it schewip sumtyme
yn medicyns maad of elebore, þer is no þing þat puttip away þe 36

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